TechNova Employee Handbook 2024

Welcome to TechNova

TechNova Solutions is a software company founded in 2016 in Austin, Texas. We build NovaCloud, a platform that helps mid-sized companies run and monitor their data pipelines. As of 2024 we employ 240 people across three offices: Austin, Dublin and Singapore.

This handbook describes how we work together. It applies to all permanent employees. Contractors are covered by the terms of their individual agreements.

Working Hours

TechNova operates on flexible hours. Employees are expected to be available during the core hours of 10:00 to 16:00 in their local time zone, and to work an average of 40 hours per week.

Teams hold a daily stand-up inside core hours. Meetings outside core hours should be recorded so colleagues in other regions can catch up.

Remote Work

All engineering roles are remote-friendly. Employees may work remotely up to four days per week, and fully remote arrangements are approved case by case by the reporting manager and the People team.

Employees working remotely from another country for more than 30 days in a calendar year must notify the People team first, because this can create tax obligations for both the employee and TechNova.

Annual Leave

Every full-time employee receives 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, in addition to local public holidays. Leave is accrued monthly at two days per month.

Up to five unused leave days may be carried over into the next year and must be used before 31 March. Leave requests are submitted in the People portal and are normally approved within three working days.

Sick Leave

Employees receive up to 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for any absence longer than three consecutive working days.

Mental health days count as sick leave. Employees do not have to explain the nature of an illness to their manager.

Parental Leave

TechNova offers 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave to the primary caregiver and 6 weeks to the secondary caregiver. Leave can be taken in up to three separate blocks during the first 18 months.

Employees returning from parental leave may work a reduced four-day week at 80 percent pay for the first three months.

Learning Budget

Each employee has an annual learning budget of 1500 USD. It can be spent on courses, conference tickets, books and certifications. The budget does not carry over to the following year.

Purchases above 500 USD need manager approval in advance. Submit receipts through the Expenses portal within 30 days of purchase.

Expense Reimbursement

Approved business expenses are reimbursed with the next monthly payroll run, provided the claim is submitted before the 25th of the month. Claims submitted later are paid the following month.

Travel must be booked through the TechNova travel portal. Economy class is standard for flights under six hours; business class may be booked for longer flights with director approval.

Equipment Policy

New employees receive a laptop, an external monitor, a keyboard and a mouse. Engineers may choose between a MacBook Pro and a Dell XPS running Ubuntu. Laptops are refreshed every three years.

Employees also receive a one-time home office allowance of 600 USD for a desk and chair. Equipment remains the property of TechNova and must be returned when employment ends.

Performance Reviews

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in March and September. Each review combines a self-assessment, manager feedback and peer feedback from at least two colleagues.

Promotion decisions and salary adjustments are made during the March cycle. Compensation changes take effect from 1 May.

Code of Conduct

TechNova does not tolerate harassment, discrimination or bullying of any kind. Concerns can be raised with a manager, with the People team, or anonymously through the ethics hotline.

All reports are investigated within 10 working days. Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is itself a serious breach of this policy.